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Professional Practices (HUM-305)

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Chap 6: WORK, Changes, Fears, and Questions

- o Impacts on Employment
- o Job Destruction and Creation
- o Changing Skills and Skill Levels
- o Telecommuting
- o A Global Workforce
- o Employee Communication and Monitoring
- o Learning About Job Applicants
- o Risks and Rules for Work and Personal Communications

1. Impacts on Employment

- Information technology and digital transformation have significantly changed the nature of employment worldwide.

Key Points

- Automation, artificial intelligence, and digital platforms are transforming traditional workplaces.
- Many routine jobs are being replaced by machines and software.
- At the same time, technology is creating entirely new industries and job categories.
- Organizations are shifting toward digital, remote, and flexible work environments.
- Employees are now expected to continuously update their technical and professional skills.

1. Impacts on Employment

Examples

- o Self-checkout machines replacing cashiers.
- o Online businesses creating jobs in digital marketing, e-commerce, and data analytics.

Conclusion

- o Technology does not simply remove jobs; it changes the types of jobs available and the skills required.

2. Job Destruction and Creation

- o Technological progress causes both job losses and job creation.

Job Destruction

- o Automation replaces repetitive and manual tasks.
- o Manufacturing and clerical jobs are often affected.
- o Example: automated factory machines replacing assembly-line workers.

Job Creation

Technology creates new fields such as:

- o Cybersecurity
- o Artificial Intelligence
- o Software Development
- o Cloud Computing
- o Data Science

2. Job Destruction and Creation

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3. Changing Skills and Skill Levels

Modern workplaces require new types of skills

- o High Demand Skills
- o Digital literacy
- o Data analysis
- o Programming and software development
- o Cybersecurity knowledge
- o Problem-solving and critical thinking

Shift in Skill Levels

- o Demand for high-skilled workers is increasing.
- o Demand for low-skilled routine jobs is decreasing.
- o Continuous learning and professional development are necessary.

Example

- o Traditional accounting tasks are automated, but accountants now need skills in financial software and data analysis.

4. Telecommuting

- o Telecommuting (remote work) allows employees to work from home or outside the traditional office using digital communication tools.

Advantages

- o Flexible working hours
- o Reduced travel time and transportation costs
- o Better work-life balance
- o Access to a wider talent pool for companies

Disadvantages

- o Reduced face-to-face collaboration
- o Possible isolation
- o Difficulty separating work and personal life
- o Security risks in remote networks

Examples of Tools

- o Video conferencing software
- o Cloud collaboration platforms
- o Project management tools

5. A Global Workforce

- o Technology enables companies to hire employees from anywhere in the world.

Key Features

- o Outsourcing and offshoring of work to other countries.
- o Online freelance platforms connecting global talent with employers.
- o Multinational teams working across different time zones.

Benefits

- o Access to specialized skills worldwide
- o Reduced labor costs
- o Increased diversity and innovation

Challenges

- o Cultural differences
- o Communication barriers
- o Legal and labor regulations in different countries

6. Employee Communication and Monitoring

- o Employers use technology to communicate with employees and monitor workplace activities.

Communication Tools

- o Email
- o Messaging platforms
- o Video meetings
- o Internal collaboration software

Monitoring Methods

- o Monitoring employee emails and internet usage
- o Tracking productivity through software
- o Recording calls in customer service departments

6. Employee Communication and Monitoring

Purpose

- o Improve productivity
- o Ensure compliance with company policies
- o Protect company data and intellectual property

Ethical Concern

- o * Excessive monitoring may invade employee privacy.

7. Learning About Job Applicants

- o Employers increasingly use digital tools to evaluate potential employees.

Methods Used

- o Online job applications
- o Social media screening
- o Background checks
- o AI-based resume screening
- o Online skill assessments

Advantages

- o Faster hiring processes
- o Ability to analyze large numbers of applicants
- o Better evaluation of skills and qualifications

Risks

- o Bias in automated systems
- o Privacy concerns
- o Misinterpretation of social media activity

8. Risks and Rules for Work and Personal Communications

Technology blurs the line between personal and professional communication

Major Risks

- o Sharing confidential information accidentally
- o Posting inappropriate content on social media
- o Cybersecurity threats such as phishing emails
- o Misuse of company communication systems

Common Workplace Rules

- o Use company email for professional communication only
- o Avoid sharing sensitive company data
- o Follow cybersecurity policies
- o Maintain respectful communication online

Best Practices

- o Think before posting or sending messages
- o Keep professional boundaries online